Supporting multilingual students

Do I support students working in an additional language?

LANGUAGE / TEACHING

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Students working in an additional language are accommodated in pace and materials

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

University contains many hidden rules: what “critical analysis” means, what a rubric is really asking for, when it is acceptable to ask for help, or what counts as “professional” behaviour. If those rules remain unspoken, familiarity can be mistaken for capability.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “Everyone else seems to know rules nobody has explained.”
- “I understand the topic, but not what I am being asked to do.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Provide extra processing time where possible.
- Release language-heavy materials early.
- Use clear structure and signposting to reduce avoidable language load.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A tutor shares discussion questions in advance and allows think time before students respond in class.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

In this course, we aim to support students working in an additional language without treating multilingualism as a deficit. If the way a class or learning activity is organised makes it harder for you to participate or…

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